4.18 Varicose Veins*

Assessment	Nursing Diagnosis	Plan / Expected Outcome	Nursing Interventions	Evaluation
Subjective • "My legs ache and feel heavy at the end of the day." **Objective** • Dilated, tortuous veins • Ankle edema	**ACTUAL** Chronic pain related to venous congestion as evidenced by aching and heaviness.	• Less discomfort within 2 weeks.	• Teach her to raise her legs when resting. • Show her how to put on compression stockings. • Encourage walking and avoiding long periods of standing.	• Outcome reached as discomfort lessens.
Subjective • "I do not like the look of my legs." **Objective** • Keeps her legs covered • Avoids short clothing	**ACTUAL** Disrupted body image related to visible varicosities as evidenced by concealment of the legs.	• Talks about her feelings and the treatment options.	• Listen to her concerns. • Explain the treatment options. • Advise on support stockings and cosmetic choices.	• Considered met once options have been discussed.
Subjective *No specific complaint* **Objective** • Venous stasis • Dry, itchy skin over the veins	**RISK** Risk for impaired skin integrity as evidenced by risk factors: venous stasis.	• Skin stays intact.	• Teach skin care and regular moisturizing. • Advise avoiding knocks and scratching. • Reinforce leg elevation and walking.	• Goal reached if skin remains intact.

* **References for this care plan:** [32], [35], [37]. Full entries are listed in the References section of the CPMN book.